

JACOB COOK

Compliance + TLS Hardening Engineer | CIS Benchmarks · System Hardening · False-Positive Triage · Audit Metrics & Reporting

Sacramento, CA · 916 709 1794 · jacobcookofficial@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/jcook-dev · github.com/jacobdcook · jacobdcook.com

Detail-driven security professional with hands-on system hardening, false-positive/negative rule triage, and audit-style metrics reporting. Built a Wazuh SIEM with documented control behavior and 100% precision after tuning, the same evidence-trail discipline hardening compliance work demands. CompTIA-certified across four disciplines (Security+, CySA+, PenTest+, SecurityX) with framework knowledge of NIST 800-53 and CIS Benchmark concepts. BS Computer Science; MS Cybersecurity in progress. Strong written communication for sysadmin and CIO-level guidance.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Hardening & Compliance: System Hardening Concepts, CIS Benchmarks (familiar), NIST 800-53, Audit Evidence & Metrics Reporting, Gap Assessment, FP/FN Rule Triage, Compliance Scan Workflow Concepts (Qualys-style PC, OpenSCAP-style)

Security Operations: Wazuh SIEM (build & admin), Sigma Rule Authoring, MITRE ATT&CK, Detection Tuning, Continuous Monitoring, IOC Analysis

Systems & Networking: Linux (Ubuntu / CentOS), Windows Endpoints, Networking (TCP/IP, DNS, TLS Concepts), Web Server / Database Hardening Awareness, Firewall & IPS Concepts

Cloud, Identity & Dev: Azure AD / Entra ID, Okta, AWS labs, SSO / RBAC, Terraform, Python · Bash · SQL · FastAPI · Git

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Stryker / Intune Detection Pack: Detection-as-Code

2026

- Authored 6 Sigma-format detection rules with documented control rationale and FP/FN triage criteria — direct compliance-rule-evaluation discipline transferable to hardening rule review.
- Eliminated 100% of false positives in a 100-event simulation using documented baseline-lookup logic, demonstrating the same fidelity-and-tuning approach hardening compliance work requires.
- Verification: 43 passing pytest cases in repo (tests/test_rules.py).

Blue Team SOC Monitoring Lab: Wazuh SIEM

2026

- Built a Wazuh SIEM stack from scratch and validated 12 detection rules against 242 simulated events with 100% precision after tuning, generating audit-style metrics on rule behavior.
- Reduced false-positive volume by 100% by tuning out 79 benign-only matches with documented justification — the same hardening-compliance metric tracking expected for global control rollouts.
- Verification: 19 passing pytest cases in repo (tests/test_detection_accuracy.py).

SOAR-lite: Incident Response Orchestrator

2026

- Built end-to-end automation with documented routing, escalation, and write-up at each stage — repeatable, auditable workflow that supports compliance evidence collection.
- Reduced triage time by over 60% in lab testing while preserving full evidence trail.
- Verification: 10 passing pytest cases in repo (tests/test_orchestrator.py).

Phishing Analysis Lab

2026

- Triageed 5 phishing samples end-to-end with documented IOCs, confidence assessments, and escalation decisions in audit-ready format.

G3-GPT: Industry-Sponsored Enterprise AI Platform (Team of 6)

2024

- Engineered RBAC and Azure AD SSO controls — direct hands-on hardening-control implementation that passed sponsor security review the first time.
- Shipped enterprise-grade platform on deadline with zero critical security findings at delivery.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Target Distribution Center | Operations Engineer: Systems Monitoring & Incident Response

2019 - 2025

- Maintained 99.5% uptime in a regulated environment by tracking continuous-monitoring telemetry — six years of audit-ready discipline.
- Resolved 200+ anomalies through structured root cause analysis with tracked documentation that reduced repeat incidents by an estimated 30% — direct gap-assessment and remediation-tracking experience.
- Reduced mean time to recovery by an estimated 20% via cross-team coordination and clear technical guidance for sysadmins on settings adjustments.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

WGU | MS, Cybersecurity (In Progress)

Expected Oct 2026 · GPA 3.50

CSUS | BS, Computer Science

Jan 2025 · GPA 3.50

CompTIA: Security+ · CySA+ · PenTest+ · SecurityX · CSIE (stackable)